
/ USER MANUAL

SNAKE

BRUTALISM

A Snake game built in Lua with LÖVE2D.
Brutalist aesthetic. Complete user documentation.

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01 – Overview

/ WHAT IS THIS

Snake / Brutalism is a Snake game built in Lua using the LÖVE2D game framework. It follows the classic rules of the Snake genre while introducing configurable game modes, cosmetic skins, power-ups, and special food items. The visual design adopts a brutalist graphic language: hard edges, heavy typography, a red and black palette, and square-pixel graphics with no rounded corners.

This document provides complete reference information for installation, navigation, and gameplay.

Design Philosophy

The game is designed around three principles:

- **All configuration before play.** Game mode, toggles, and skin are selected from dedicated screens before a session begins.
- **No hidden mechanics.** Every active modifier — slow time, speed level, special food countdown — is communicated visually on screen at all times.
- **Consistent visual language.** Menus, overlays, and in-game elements share the same typographic system, palette, and layout conventions.

02 – System Requirements

/ WHAT YOU NEED

COMPONENT	REQUIREMENT
Runtime	LÖVE2D 11.5 — download at love2d.org
Language	Lua 5.4 (bundled with LÖVE2D, no separate install needed)
OS	Windows 10/11 · macOS 12+ · Linux x86-64
Storage	Less than 5 MB (fonts + source)
Audio	Any output device — sound is synthesized at runtime
Display	Minimum 660 × 560 px available window area

No internet connection is required after the initial download. All sound effects are generated programmatically — no audio files are bundled.

03 – Installation

/ GETTING STARTED

Step 1 – Install LÖVE2D

Download LÖVE2D 11.5 from love2d.org and install it. On Windows, use the 64-bit installer. Note the installation path (typically C:\Program Files\LÖVE).

Step 2 – Obtain the Game Files

Clone the repository or download the source archive:

```
git clone https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/snake-brutalism
```

Step 3 – Verify Folder Structure

The `fonts/` directory must be present alongside `main.lua`. The game will not start if fonts are missing.

```
snake-brutalism/  
  main.lua  
  README.md  
  .luarc.json  
  fonts/  
    Anton-Regular.ttf  
    ArchivoBlack-Regular.ttf  
    SpaceMono-Bold.ttf
```

Step 4 – Run the Game

Option A – Drag and drop: drag the project folder onto `love.exe`.

Option B – Terminal:

```
"C:\Program Files\LÖVE\love-11.5-win64.exe" "C:\pathtosnake-brutalism"
```

Option C – PATH method (recommended): add the LÖVE directory to your system PATH, then from any terminal:

```
love snake-brutalism
```

To add LÖVE to PATH on Windows: search “Environment Variables” in the Start menu, edit the Path variable, and add the LÖVE installation folder. Restart any open terminal for the change to take effect.

04 – Main Menu

/ ENTRY SCREEN

The main menu is displayed on launch. It features a snake icon in the shape of the letter S, the game title, and the following options:

KEY	ACTION
Enter	Start a session with the last configured mode and settings
G	Open the Game Mode selection and Setup screen
S	Open the Skin selection screen
Esc	Quit the application

Pressing **Enter** from the main menu starts immediately using the last saved configuration. To change mode or options, press **G** first.

05 – Game Modes

/ HOW THE FIELD BEHAVES

Two modes are available, selectable via **G** from the main menu.

Classic

Standard Snake rules. The playing field is bounded on all four sides. Any collision with the outer wall ends the session immediately. No structural challenge beyond the snake’s own body is introduced by the mode itself.

Obstacles

An escalating challenge mode. The field begins empty, but internal wall segments are added as the player accumulates points.

THRESHOLD	EVENT
Every 40 points	3 new wall segments are placed on the field
Progressively	Walls accumulate and are never removed during a session

Wall segments are rendered as dark blocks with a red border and a diagonal danger stripe. Placement rules:

- Never within 4 cells of the snake’s current head (safe zone).
- Never on a cell occupied by the snake, food, power-up, or special food.
- Never adjacent to the outer boundary.
- A short audio cue sounds each time new walls appear.

Obstacle mode is fully compatible with the No Walls toggle (Section 06). When both are active, the outer boundary wraps around but internal wall segments remain lethal.

06 – Session Setup

/ CONFIGURING YOUR MATCH

After selecting a mode and pressing **Enter**, the Setup screen is displayed. Navigate rows with **W** / **S**. Toggle with **Enter** or the arrow keys. Press **M** to go back. Navigate to **START GAME** and press **Enter** to begin the session.

OPTION	DEFAULT	DESCRIPTION
Speed Up / 30 pts	ON	Movement interval decreases each time the score reaches a multiple of 30. Cumulative and permanent for the session.
Power-Ups	OFF	Enables the Slow Time power-up. See Section 10.
Special Food	OFF	Enables the high-value food item that expires after a fixed duration. See Section 10.
No Walls	OFF	Removes outer boundary lethality. The snake exits one edge and re-enters from the opposite side. Compatible with both modes.

07 – Controls

/ KEYBOARD REFERENCE

In-Game

KEY	ACTION
↑ W	Move up
↓ S	Move down
← A	Move left
→ D	Move right
P	Pause the current session
Esc	Quit the application immediately

Menus and Overlays

KEY	ACTION
Enter Space	Confirm / Start / Restart
A D	Browse (Mode and Skin screens)
W S	Navigate rows (Setup screen)
G	Game Mode screen (main menu only)
S	Skin screen (main menu only)
P	Resume from pause (triggers countdown)
M	Return to previous screen or main menu

Direction reversal is not permitted. Pressing the key directly opposite the current direction of travel has no effect.

08 – Gameplay

/ CORE MECHANICS

Objective

Guide the snake to consume food items. Each item increases the snake's length by one segment and awards points. The session ends on collision with an outer wall (if No Walls is off), the snake's own body, or an obstacle (Obstacles mode).

Scoring

EVENT	POINTS
Standard food consumed	+10
Special food consumed	+50
Power-up collected	0 (effect only — no points)
Collision	Session ends

Speed Progression

When **Speed Up** is enabled, the movement interval decreases each time the score reaches a multiple of 30. The effect is cumulative and does not reset between levels in Obstacles mode. The current speed level appears in the HUD under **SPEED**.

Death and Restart

On collision, a screen-shake effect and death sound trigger simultaneously. The Game Over overlay shows the final score and current best. Two options:

- **Enter** or **Space** — restart with the same mode and settings.
- **M** — return to the main menu.

BEST is retained in memory for the application run. It is not saved to disk.

09 – Skins

/ SNAKE APPEARANCE

Press **S** from the main menu. Browse with **A** / **D**, preview the live snake in the card, and confirm with **Enter**. Press **M** to return without changing. The active skin is labeled [**SELECTED**].

The active skin determines the color of the snake, the eat particles, and the 3·2·1·GO countdown numbers.

SKIN	HEAD	BODY STYLE
BRUTAL	Red	Off-white / gray alternating — black center stripe

PURPLE	Yellow	Mid-purple / dark purple alternating
JUNGLE	Amber	Olive green / dark green alternating
QUETZAL	Gold	Emerald / teal alternating — gold border detail

All skins share the same brutalist block style: square segments, hard edges, no rounding, and a directional square eye on the head that tracks direction of movement.

10 – Power-ups & Special Food

/ BONUS ITEMS

Both item types must be enabled in Session Setup. They are always placed on free cells — never overlapping the snake, food, obstacles, or each other.

Slow Time Power-up

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Appearance	Blue square block with clock hands in black
Spawn rate	One item every 8–15 seconds (randomized)
Visibility	6 seconds on the field before auto-disappearing
Effect	Halves the snake’s movement speed for 5 seconds
Visual cue	A blue bar labeled SLOW X.Xs appears at the top of the field
On collect	Ascending arpeggio + blue particle burst

The Slow Time effect doubles the movement interval (half speed). Especially useful in Obstacles mode when navigating dense wall clusters at higher scores.

Special Food

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Appearance	Rotating gold diamond with black inner square
Spawn rate	One item every 10–18 seconds (randomized)
Visibility	5 seconds before expiring
Points	+50 — five times the value of standard food
Timer bar	Gold bar above the cell counts down remaining time. Item flashes in the final second.

On collect	Ascending arpeggio + gold particle burst
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Special food causes the snake to grow by one segment, identical to standard food. The two item types are fully independent.

11 – HUD Reference

/ READING THE INTERFACE

The HUD occupies the bar at the top of the window, separated from the playing field by a red horizontal line. Three values are displayed:

LABEL	DESCRIPTION
SCORE	Points accumulated in the current session
SPEED	Current speed level. Starts at 1. Increments by 1 every 30 points when Speed Up is enabled.
BEST	Highest score achieved since the application was launched. Resets to 0 on quit.

Each label is displayed in red above its value. Values use the Space Mono typeface.

In-Game Overlays

ELEMENT	DESCRIPTION
SLOW X.Xs bar	Blue progress bar at the top of the field. Active when Slow Time is in effect.
Special food bar	Gold bar above the special food cell. Counts down remaining visibility.
3· 2· 1· GO	Countdown on resume from pause. Color matches the active skin’s head.

12 – Pause & Navigation

/ PAUSING AND RETURNING TO MENU

Pausing

Press **P** during an active session to pause. The game state freezes completely — the snake, all item lifetimes, the slow time effect, and all timers halt.

KEY	ACTION
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P	Resume — triggers the 3· 2· 1· GO countdown
M	Return to the main menu — the current session is abandoned

Resume Countdown

When resuming from pause, a countdown sequence (3 — 2 — 1 — GO) is displayed over the frozen field. Numbers render in the head color of the active skin with a black outline. Gameplay resumes immediately after GO completes.

This countdown does **not** appear when starting a new session from the menu. It is exclusive to the pause-resume flow and exists to prevent the player from being caught off guard on return.

Game Over Navigation

After a session ends, the Game Over overlay shows the final score and the current best. Two options are available:

KEY	ACTION
Enter Space	Restart with the same mode and settings
M	Return to the main menu